



Google's Verified Messages

Google Messages has rolled out Verified Messages which protects users against scams and phishing. <https://dgit.in/dec19-36>



Super Telephoto Periscope Lens

Rumours indicate that the Vivo X30 will have a 'Super Telephoto Periscope' camera as part of its quad-cam setup. <https://dgit.in/dec19-37>

Lenovo IdeaPad C340

A confused 14-incher

Lenovo's new convertible, the IdeaPad C340, starts at a pocket-friendly price of ₹46,190 and goes all the way up to ₹89,490. Along the price band, you get to pick a variant with either an Intel Core i3, i5, or i7 CPU. You also get to pick a variant with either integrated or discrete graphics. This makes it highly configurable. Let's see how it fared.

Build and design

The IdeaPad C340 is built well and looks professional. It uses metal in the top cover and plastic for the base panel. It is a fairly slim laptop that's easy to grip. Sadly, it's not lightweight, weighing in at 1.65 kgs. Opening the lid reveals a glossy 14-inch display with fairly slim bezels on three sides. The display hinge feels sturdy. There's no play or wobble when the device is switched between laptop and tablet modes.

Keyboard and touchpad

The keycaps are large enough but are not shaped right for easy pressing. They lack depth and sufficient feedback too. That said, they're not terrible for everyday typing. This keyboard is fine for emails and short documents. On the plus side, there's two-stage backlighting, for all those late-night compositions.

The touchpad, being a modern precision unit, is great for single- and multi-finger taps and swipes. The surface is large and smooth for easy operation. The two click keys beneath the surface are fairly easy to press, although a bit more suppleness would not have gone amiss.

Display, touch, audio and IO

The IdeaPad C340 features a 14-inch touchscreen panel with Full HD resolution. Colours on the unit are a little warmer than usual but that makes



Price
₹46,190
(base)



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reading an easy affair. Brightness, sadly, is on the lower side.

The display that can be pushed all the way back into tablet mode. It also comes bundled with a Lenovo Active Pen stylus. The display's surface has good accuracy in palm rejection but could do with better.

The surface is otherwise smooth and convenient for drawing.

The sound from the two down-firing speakers is loud enough to fill an office bay but not very clear.

Coming to IO, on the left side we see a power port, an HDMI port, a USB-C 3.1 port, and a 3.5mm audio jack. On the right side, we see two USB-A 3.1 ports, and a full-size SD Card slot. The power button is also here, so the laptop can be started up even in tablet mode. But the button is hard to find and has very little feedback. Below the backlit keyboard is a squarish fingerprint scanner, which works swiftly with Windows Hello for user sign-in and in-app authentication.

Performance

Our review unit was powered by an Intel 8th Gen Core i5 CPU, an Nvidia GeForce MX230 graphics card, and 8GB of RAM. Thanks to the MX230 GPU, the IdeaPad C340 gets 2GB of dedicated video RAM, something that not many

convertibles offer in the Indian market. It performed very well on CPU and GPU benchmark tests. On PCMark 8's Accelerated Creative test, the review unit collected 3749 points. On 3DMark's Fire Strike and Cloud Gate, the review unit picked up 2427 and 7921 points, respectively, which is very good. Everyday performance of the review unit was quite good. We were able to multitask on numerous applications across multiple virtual desktops without facing any signs of stuttering. Gaming, however, was a strained affair on the review unit. On our standard battery benchmark test, the review unit managed to hold up for 3 hours, 38 minutes, which is quite mediocre.

Bottomline

Unlike the thin and light laptop market, the convertible laptop market is still far from being heavily populated with affordable models. The Lenovo IdeaPad C340 creates a noticeable difference on that front because it is a proper convertible that costs only about half a lakh rupees. It also brings discrete graphics in the form of an Nvidia GeForce MX230 GPU. The Lenovo IdeaPad C340 is a fine convertible laptop with sufficient power for everyday tasks. With the inbuilt dedicated GPU, you can even try your hand at gaming. Its display, though not bright enough, is good for annotation and doodling with the bundled stylus. However, at 1.65 kilogrammes, it's quite heavy for tablet use. Its battery life, too, is disappointingly short. If you can live with those two issues, the Lenovo IdeaPad C340 is a convertible worth picking.

—Vignesh Girdharan

SPECIFICATIONS

FORM FACTOR: Convertible 2 in 1 | SCREEN SIZE: 14 Inches | MAXIMUM DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 1920 x 1080 (Full HD) | ITEM WEIGHT: 1.65 Kg | PRODUCT DIMENSIONS: 32.8 x 22.9 x 1.8 cm | PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7 | PROCESSOR SPEED: 1.8 GHz | RAM: 16 GB DDR4 | HARD DRIVE SIZE: 1 TB Flash Solid State | SPEAKER DESCRIPTION: 2x 1.5W, without mesh | GRAPHICS COPROCESSOR: NVIDIA MX230 2GB GDDR5 | I/O: 2 USB 3.0, 1 HDMI, 1 audio-out, 1 microphone port | OPERATING SYSTEM: Windows 10 Home

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